

# WRITTEN ASSIGNMENT

## Guidelines for the Creation of a Written Assignment

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Good academic writing does not simply take any result or theoretical position and assume it to be true. Instead, it seeks to prove or disprove the result or position by supporting or countering it with the use of reliable sources and facts.

## **1. OBJECTIVES OF ACADEMIC WRITING**

A written assignment should demonstrate the academic writing capabilities of the student. In this assignment, students are expected to show that they are capable of selecting an academic topic, undertaking the relevant research, and using that research to support their own thoughts and insights.

## **2. STRUCTURE OF A WRITTEN ASSIGNMENT**

The structure of the assignment should reflect a logical progression of main points and explanatory points. The text should be a coherent and cohesive whole and follow a linear structure. There should be a logical integration of the main and explanatory points across the various sections, with clear transitions between them. Referring to a key argument in a previous paragraph, for example, can create connections between the points. The main body of the assignment is composed of the core argument (around 70% of the assignment) and is preceded by an introduction (around 20%) and followed by a conclusion (around 10%).

### **2.1 Introduction**

The introduction is the first paragraph of an assignment and should be created as an integral part of the text. The introduction should succinctly but clearly convey the following points, which will then be elaborated upon in the main body of the text:

- Rationale for subject selection according to recent studies on the chosen topic (Why is the topic relevant and what open questions, discussed in the body of the assignment, does it raise?) This is where you should refer to your chosen question.
- Aim of the assignment or the examination (What does the assignment aim to examine or prove?)
- Topic boundaries and necessary definitions (What is beyond the scope of the assignment? What is within range? What should be the scope of the intended outcomes?)
- Outline of the structure and the arguments within the assignment (What can the reader expect in the main body, and what structure does the assignment follow?)

The introduction should be thought about early in the planning process, even if it is written last. Thereby, the introduction helps to clearly cover the assignment's key arguments and ensure a logical argumentation process within the assignment itself, resulting in a meaningful solution.

### **2.2 Main Body**

### **2.3 Conclusion**

## **3. FORMAL GUIDELINES AND SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS**

### **3.1 Components of the Written Assignment**

The written assignment consists of the following parts, listed in the table of contents (except for title page and table of contents):

- Title page
- Table of contents

- List of figures and/or tables (if necessary)
- Table of abbreviations (if necessary)
- Text part with introduction, main part, conclusion
- Bibliography
- List of appendices (if necessary)
- Appendices and materials (if necessary)

### 3.2 Formalities

| Formalities                          | Explanation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Length BACHELOR                      | 7–10 pages of text                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Length MASTER                        | 12–15 pages of text                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Paper size                           | A4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Margins                              | Top and bottom 2cm; left 2cm; right 2cm                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Page numbers                         | Centered at the end of the page<br><br>Apart from the title page, all pages must be numbered. The pages before the body of the text (if applicable, e.g. title page, table of contents, list of tables and abbreviations) should be numbered in Roman capital letters (I, II, III, IV, etc.), with the page number not appearing on page I (title page). The pages of the text part are numbered with Arabic numbers (1, 2, 3, etc.). These page numbers are continued to the end, i.e., also through the appendix (if applicable). |
| Font                                 | General text: Arial 11 pt.; headings: Arial 12 pt.; justified                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Line spacing                         | 1.5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Sentences                            | Justified; hyphenation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Footnotes                            | Arial 10 pt., justified                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Paragraphs                           | According to conceptual structure – 6 pt. spacing after line breaks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Title page                           | The title page should contain at least the following elements: title of thesis, type of thesis, course name, course of study, date, author's name, matriculation number, tutor's name.<br>Course-specific adaptations of the information are possible.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Sections and subsections             | A maximum of three levels (1. Main heading, 1.1 Section, 1.1.1 Subheading)<br><br>Only individual chapters in the text of the assignment are numbered consecutively; otherwise, sections of the assignment, such as the list of figures and/or tables or the bibliography, are not numbered.<br><br>Do not underline; use <i>italics</i> sparingly to emphasize passages.                                                                                                                                                           |
| Citation standard                    | Please refer to the citation guidelines on myCampus.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Anti-plagiarism pledge and affidavit | This pledge must be submitted electronically (via myCampus) before you can submit your assignment.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Submission                           | Please refer to the corresponding guidelines in myCampus – Turnitin.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

### 3.3 Evaluation

The evaluation criteria and their corresponding weight are listed below.

| Evaluation Criteria | Explanation                                          | Weight |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Introduction        | Introduction, definition of topic and thematic scope | 8%     |
| Structure           | Composition and structure                            | 16%    |
| Reasoning           | Quality of argument and research                     | 40%    |
| Conclusion          | Conclusion and recommendations                       | 16%    |
| Language            | Linguistic expression and spelling                   | 10%    |
| Neatness            | Neatness in formatting and correct citations         | 10%    |

**Good luck with your written assignment!**